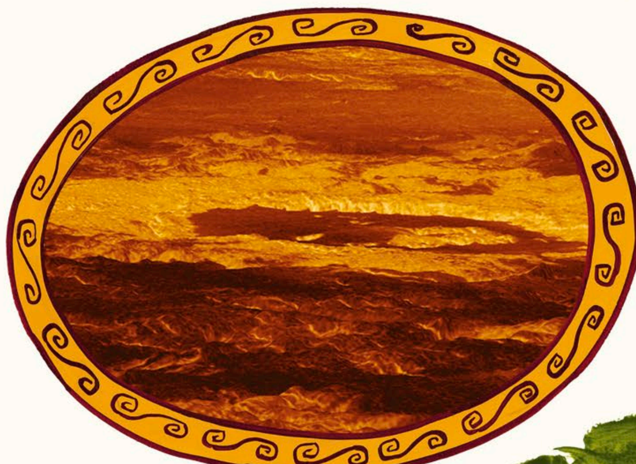
During a lunar eclipse, the full moon changes color as it moves into and out of Earth's shadow.

Lunar legacy

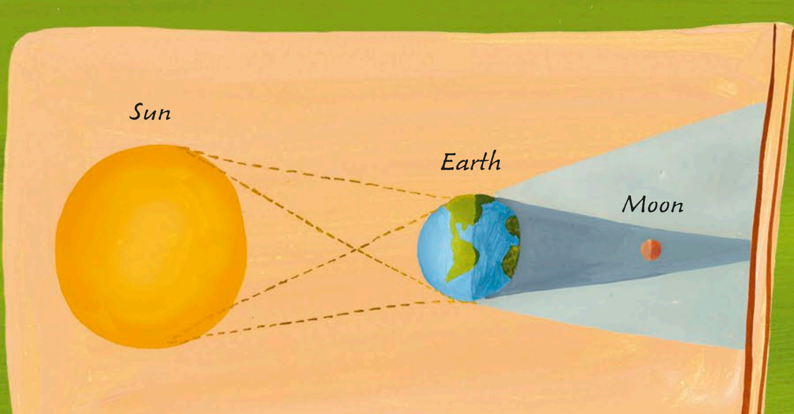
Of course, Aganice didn't really have magical powers. Just like today's scientists, she had learned that nature is not as chaotic as it seems. Aganice saw an order in things—the movements of the sun, the moon, stars, and planets follow rules, which make them predictable.

The ancient Greeks even created a device—called the Antikythera mechanism—to calculate positions of objects in the sky many years into the future. It is probably the oldest mechanical computer-like tool in the world. Devices like this may have helped Aganice to predict lunar eclipses, cycles the moon still follows to this day.

The Aglaonice crater on Venus is named after Aganice.



There is a Greek saying: "Yes, as the moon obeys Aganice," which means "That's for sure!"



Lunar eclipse

Total lunar eclipses happen when the sun, the Earth, and the moon are perfectly lined up in space, with the Earth in the middle. Our planet blocks most of the sun's light from getting to the moon. The little light that does get through makes the moon look red or orange.